

CFES

*CANADIAN FEDERATION
OF ENGINEERING STUDENTS*



FCEG

*LA FÉDÉRATION CANADIENNE
ÉTUDIANTE EN GÉNIE*

Canadian Federation of Engineering Students

Team Bylaws

English Edition

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1 Terms & Definitions

Term	Definition
CFES	Abbreviation for the Canadian Federation of Engineering Students
Articles	The original or restated articles of incorporation or articles of amendment, amalgamation, continuance, reorganization, arrangement or revival of CFES.
Resolution	A motion presented as a proposal and approved by majority vote, or the applicable voting threshold if otherwise specified
Special Resolution	A Resolution approved by a two-thirds (2/3) majority vote
Member, Member Society	A recognized engineering student society representing students at a Canadian post-secondary institution that has been admitted to membership in the CFES in accordance with this Constitution
National Executive	The President and the Vice-Presidents
Leadership Team	The Directors and National Executive
CFES Team	The Leadership Team, Commissioners, and Activity Managers
Activity	A conference, competition, or other event organized by the CFES for its Members
Host Society	The Member Society responsible for an Activity of the CFES
Activity Manager(s)	The person chiefly responsible for the organization of an Activity on behalf of a Host Society
General Meeting	A meeting of the Members
CELC	The Canadian Engineering Leadership Conference
CSE	The Conference on Sustainability in Engineering.
CEC	The Canadian Engineering Competition
CESS	The Canadian Engineering Spring Summit
SDES	The Summit on the Development of Engineering Societies
CDE	The Conference on Diversity in Engineering

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Document of Stances

A document that contains the official positions taken by the CFES.

Regional Agreement

A document outlining the relationship between the CFES and the organizations representing each region recognized by the CFES.

2 National Executive

2.1 Overview of National Executive

1. The National Executive is the elected leadership of the CFES and consists of the following five positions:
 - (a) President
 - (b) Vice President Academic
 - (c) Vice President Finance
 - (d) Vice President External
 - (e) Vice President Services
 - (f) Vice President Communications
2. The National Executive's general tasks and responsibilities include:
 - (a) Upholding the Constitution, Bylaws, and Policies of the CFES
 - (b) Organizing and directing the efforts of the CFES
 - (c) Ensuring the completion of all mandates
 - (d) Managing Commissioners within their respective portfolios, and assuming responsibilities in the event they are not completed
 - (e) Making contact with government bodies when necessary
 - (f) Hiring working groups for their successors as required by April 30th
 - (g) Creating a transition document by April 30th to be stored in the electronic CFES archive

2.2 President

1. The President's tasks and responsibilities include:
 - (a) Providing leadership and oversight for the National Executive
 - (b) Ensuring the mandates of each Vice President are completed
 - (c) Organizing meetings of the National Executive

- (d) Ensuring that long term planning for the CFES is undertaken, with annual updates given to the Members
- (e) Maintaining communication channels with all stakeholders of the CFES
- (f) Ensuring communication with Engineers Canada and attending the Engineers Canada Annual General Meeting and Board Meetings, if feasible

2.3 Vice President Academic (VPA)

1. The VPA's tasks and responsibilities include:

- (a) Developing an understanding of academic initiatives, integrated work experience, curriculum content, accreditation standards and requirements as well as any changes which could affect engineering education
- (b) Determining the academic, moral, intellectual, cultural, social, and economic needs of Canadian engineering students, working towards changes if necessary, and offering national leverage in issues of negotiation between student representation and administration at Members' institutions and other relevant organizations
- (c) Communicating relevant information and issues related to engineering education or that affect the Canadian engineering student population to Members and Engineering Deans Canada
- (d) Facilitating the exchange of relevant academic information and advocacy efforts between Members and national educational organizations
- (e) Attending Canadian Engineering Accreditation Board and Engineering Deans Canada meetings and providing highlights of the meetings to the Board
- (f) Managing advocacy in relation to the Document of Stances
- (g) Directing the Advocacy Working Group, which shall support the VPA portfolio through advocacy tasks including but not limited to research, resource creation, and statement writing on topics related to the CFES's Stances or other concerns from Members.
- (h) Providing support to the advocacy efforts of Members where it aligns with the CFES's efforts, including but not limited to letters of support.

2.4 Vice President Finance (VPF)

1. The VPF's tasks and responsibilities include:

- (a) Acting as the treasurer of CFES by:
 - i. Issuing outgoing payments
 - ii. Depositing incoming funds
 - iii. Tracking all financial assets
 - iv. Keeping a complete and accurate record of all previous years' financial records
 - v. Creating and maintaining current and historical financial statements (income statement, balance sheet and cash flow statement)

- vi. Ensuring an annual audit of the CFES' finances is completed
- (b) Ensuring the timely change of Signing Officers on the CFES accounts at the end of the fiscal year.
- (c) Preparing a list of membership fee collection information for the current and previous year
- (d) Collecting the number of students represented by each Member each year
- (e) Submitting a proposed detailed budget for the incoming year to the Board
- (f) Documenting the support for expenses and revenues, including receipts, invoices, minutes approving expenditures, and any other necessary documents.

2.4.2 Outgoing Vice-President Finance

1. The Outgoing VPF's tasks and responsibilities include:
 - (a) Working alongside the VPF through the early months of their term
 - (b) Finalizing the financial statements for the fiscal year of their mandate
 - (c) Ensuring the completion of the audit for the fiscal year of their mandate.

2.5 Vice President External (VPE)

1. The VPE's tasks and responsibilities include:
 - (a) Acting as the primary contact of the CFES to existing and prospective national and international partners
 - (b) Exploring new projects and cooperation ideas with existing and prospective national and international partners
 - (c) Ensuring that all partners and developing partners are invited to all relevant events
 - (d) Promoting international opportunities and the benefits of international cooperation to the Members
 - (e) Providing regular updates on relevant projects, initiatives, and ongoing work of partners and the outcomes of these partnerships

2.6 Vice President Services (VPS)

1. The VPS's tasks and responsibilities include:
 - (a) Being chiefly responsible for all CFES Activities and overseeing Activity Managers.
 - (b) Planning, scheduling, and hosting monthly check-in meetings with the Activity Managers.
 - (c) Ensuring that the responsibilities outlined in the Activity Agreements are completed.

- (d) Organizing transition reports, transition meetings with outgoing and incoming team, and financial closeout of Activities.
- (e) Encouraging Members to bid and host Activities
- (f) Supporting Members in their bids to host Activities
- (g) Collecting feedback from delegates following Activities within a month of the completion of the Activity.

2.7 Vice President Communications (VPC)

1. The VPC's tasks and responsibilities include:
 - (a) Maintaining and upkeeping an archive of original files relating to the logo, banners, branded items, and templates of the CFES.
 - (b) Maintaining and enforcing the logo and branding guidelines of the CFES
 - (c) Assisting Activities with the creation of design templates for documents or promotional materials, as necessary
 - (d) Sourcing quotes for branded items for the CFES or its Activities as necessary
 - (e) Updating social media profiles for the CFES
 - (f) Directing the Media & Marketing Working Group, which shall make graphics, research trends, and provide new ideas on how to best use the CFES socials.
 - (g) Directing the Bilingualism Working Group, which shall support translation, make plans to improve bilingualism at Activities or online meetings, and help make bilingualism resources for others.
 - (h) Facilitating engagement between Members throughout the year.
 - (i) Sending out publications to the Members every other month to keep them up to date with the progress of the CFES Team.

3 Chair

3.1 Purpose

1. To provide leadership and oversight for the Board and General Meetings.
2. To facilitate orderly, transparent, and effective governance and decision-making.
3. To ensure that meetings are properly convened, prepared for, conducted, and documented in accordance with the Constitution and Bylaws.
4. To support effective communication and participation among Members and the Leadership Team.
5. To ensure the organization maintains proper corporate governance and fulfills its obligations under the CNCA and applicable law.

6. To serve as the organization's primary point of responsibility for incorporation and ongoing corporate compliance matters.

3.2 Responsibilities

1. Chairing meetings of the Board, including:
 - (a) Calling meetings of the Board in accordance with the Constitution.
 - (b) Distributing meeting minutes to the Board for approval.
 - (c) Submitting approved minutes to be distributed publicly.
2. Chairing General Meetings, including:
 - (a) Ensuring, in conjunction with the relevant Activity Manager, that sufficient time and resources are scheduled to complete all proceedings,
 - (b) Ensuring that Members are made aware of the meetings as required by the Constitution,
 - (c) Ensuring that Members are adequately prepared for the meeting by providing them with previous meeting minutes, and any other relevant documents,
 - (d) Ensuring that a process exists for Members to submit proposals and counter-proposals,
 - (e) Ensuring that a preliminary agenda is circulated as required for each meeting,
3. In the absence of the Chair, the responsibilities above are to be completed by the Vice-Chair.
 - (a) The Board shall designate a member of the Leadership Team as Vice-Chair, who is to fulfill the duties of the Chair in their absence.
 - (b) The President shall not be eligible to fill the position of Vice-Chair.
4. Acting as the ex-officio Chief Returning Officer
5. Dealing with all incorporation matters, including filing the Annual Summary with Corporations Canada each year.
6. Ensuring continued compliance with the CNCA and applicable law.

4 Regional Ambassadors

4.1 Purpose

1. Regional Ambassadors are nominated by their respective region to represent them on the Board.
2. The four Regional Ambassadors shall be:
 - (a) West Ambassador
 - (b) Ontario Ambassador

- (c) Quebec Ambassador
- (d) Atlantic Ambassador

4.2 Regional Agreements

1. The CFES shall maintain contracts with the organizations corresponding to the regions of the CFES, known as Regional Agreements.

4.3 Responsibilities

1. Regional Ambassadors' tasks and responsibilities include:
 - (a) Maintaining open lines of communication between CFES and Members in their region, and bringing their region's perspective forward in Board meetings.
 - (b) Assisting in the review Regional Agreements annually
 - (c) Facilitating the use of proxy votes in General Meetings as necessary.
 - (d) Encouraging the members of their region to participate in and/or organize CFES events
 - (e) Encouraging students to run for CFES positions.
 - (f) Assisting the VPF in the collection of membership fees.
 - (g) Conducting CFES introduction and update sessions for Members in their region.
 - (h) Ensuring the CFES is represented at major regional activities, such as AGMs, regional competitions and regional meetings.
 - (i) Holding regional meetings at CELC and any other relevant Activities.
 - (j) Meeting with the Members of their region before all Activities to inform the Members of expectations for the Activity.
 - (k) Meet with their constituencies after all General Meetings to review the outcomes of the General Meetings.
 - (l) Creating a transition document by April 30th to be stored in the electronic CFES archive.

5 National Councillors

5.1 Purpose

1. The CFES shall elect two (2) National Councillors annually to serve as Directors and to support its Mission.

5.2 Responsibilities

1. Responsibilities of the National Councillors include:

- (a) Advising and supporting the CFES Team and Members with institutional knowledge
- (b) Ensuring a smooth transition of the CFES Team

6 Commissioners

6.1 Nomination and Ratification

- 1. The Board, on recommendation of the National Executive, may appoint the Commissioners for the purpose of assisting with the National Executives' respective portfolios.

6.2 Term of Office

- 1. The term of office of the Commissioners is the same as that of the National Executive.

6.3 Dismissal

- 1. A Commissioner may be dismissed by a Special Resolution of the Board..

6.4 Vacancy

- 1. Provided a vacancy occurs, the Board, on recommendation of the National Executive, may appoint a Commissioner by interim until the end of the term of office.

6.5 Remuneration

- 1. The Commissioners shall serve without remuneration and no Commissioner shall directly or indirectly receive any profit from holding the position, provided that reasonable expenses incurred in the exercise of the Commissioner's duties are reimbursed.

7 Amendments

- 1. Subject to the Articles, the Board may, by Resolution, make, amend or repeal any provisions of these Bylaws that regulate the activities or affairs of the CFES, except in respect of matters referred to in subsection 197(1) of the Act.
- 2. Any such amendment or repeal shall be effective from the date of the Board Resolution until the next General Meeting where it may be confirmed, rejected or amended by the Members by Resolution.
 - (a) If the amendment or repeal is confirmed or confirmed as amended by the Members, it remains effective in the form in which it was confirmed.

- (b) The amendment or repeal ceases to have effect if it is not submitted to the Members at the next General Meeting or if it is rejected by the Members at the General Meeting.
- (c) If an amendment or a repeal ceases to have effect, a subsequent Board resolution that has substantially the same purpose or effect is not effective until it is confirmed, or confirmed as amended, by the Members at a General Meeting.
- (d) This does not apply to any amendment that requires a Special Resolution of the Members under subsection 197(1) (fundamental change) of the Act because such amendments or repeals are only effective when confirmed by the Members.

8 Invalidation

1. The invalidity or unenforceability of any provision of these Bylaws shall not affect the validity or enforceability of the remaining provisions of these Bylaws. If any of the provisions contained in the Bylaws are inconsistent with those contained in the Constitution, the Articles or the Act, the provisions contained in the Constitution, the Articles or the Act, as the case may be, shall prevail.
2. Titles inserted in these Bylaws are included only to facilitate reading and should not affect their interpretation.
3. In these Bylaws and in all other documents of the CFES hereafter passed, unless the context otherwise requires, words importing the singular number shall include the plural number, and vice versa, and references to persons shall include firms and corporations.
4. In the case of a discrepancy between the English and French versions of these Bylaws, the English version takes precedence.

9 Superseding

1. In the event of a conflict between these Bylaws and the following documents, the following documents shall prevail in the order in which they are listed:
 - (a) The Canada Not-For-Profit Corporations Act
 - (b) The Articles
 - (c) The Constitution